

Design Spec — minimoi.ai Preview Layer + Guest Access

mini-moi · Guild Created: 2026-06-13 — Claude.ai Status: Design — approach locked, build spec to follow For: Claude Code (build spec) + Grok (German animation concept)

Decision: Two-tier access model

Approach is locked. This document moves directly from design to build spec input — no further design iteration needed on the access model itself.

Tier	Who	What they see	Always on?
Preview	Anyone (LinkedIn, GitHub, recruiters)	Static snapshot of all domains, frozen data, snapshot banner	Yes — static, no Mac needed
Guest	Vetted contacts (Robert grants on request)	Live app, real data, read-only	No — requires Mac + tunnel
Owner	Robert	Full app	No — Mac + tunnel

Preview is the missing middle that currently doesn't exist. Guest plumbing already exists (`/register`, Telegram ping, `/guest/briefing`). Both tiers are in scope for this spec; the build priorities are Preview first (highest job-search value, most work), Guest cleanup second (confirm it works cleanly as-is or identify what's broken).

Tier 1 — Static Snapshot Preview

Concept

A `/preview` section of minimoi.ai (or a subdomain — see open question below) serving pre-rendered HTML/CSS of all three domains. Real data, real UI, frozen at the time of last snapshot. A persistent banner identifies it as a snapshot demonstration. Hosted statically — always up, no Mac needed.

What's included

All three domains, all key pages:

Curator

- Daily Briefing / top stories view (the 7 AM output, real scored stories)
- Deeper Dive example (one story with Synthesizer + Challenger output)
- Archive/browse view showing the article list

Mein Deutsch

- Lesen tab (reading passage + questions)
- Gespräche tab — static view of a completed session (transcript + feedback)
- Wörter tab (Anki card examples)
- Schreiben tab (writing prompt + correction example)
- See German section below for the additional animation layer

Guild

- Daily Briefing (`/guild`) — the full at-a-glance view
- Build Log — showing real spec history (including specs that produced this very preview)
- Career Focus pipeline — **redacted** (see below)

Admin tabs: visible but blocked

Admin tabs (Curator Admin, Mein Deutsch Admin, Guild Admin) are visible in navigation — hiding them would misrepresent the actual product. Clicking any admin tab shows a modal or inline message:

Admin — not available in preview This section is available to authenticated users.
Request guest access from Robert to see it live.

Modal should match the site's existing design (dark background, parchment text, amber accent button for the "Request access" link — which opens a pre-populated email or links to the contact method Robert chooses).

Career pipeline: redact in snapshot

The Career Focus pipeline contains private data (company names, contacts, pipeline stage). Two options for Claude Code to evaluate and recommend:

- **Option A:** Exclude Career Focus entirely from the preview — Guild Daily Briefing shows the countdown and aggregate counts ("12 opportunities, 1 interview") but no pipeline table
- **Option B:** Show the pipeline with company names replaced by "[Company A]", "[Company B]" etc. and contact names removed — preserves the UI/UX demonstration without exposing real data

Robert's preference: **Option A** unless the pipeline UI is particularly impressive to show, in which case a scrubbed Option B is fine. Claude Code to recommend which looks better once the rest of the preview is built.

Snapshot banner

Persistent across all preview pages — top of every page, non-dismissable:

Preview snapshot — This is a read-only demonstration of mini-moi, captured [Month YYYY]. Data is real but frozen. [Request live guest access →]

Design: thin banner, amber/parchment on dark background, consistent with existing site palette. Does not obscure nav or content.

Refresh workflow

Robert refreshes the snapshot periodically (monthly cadence or after a major feature ships). The mechanism should be a single command:

```
bash

python tools/capture_snapshot.py
```

This script:

1. Hits each page of the live app (authenticated as owner)
2. Saves rendered HTML + assets to `static/preview/`
3. Injects the snapshot banner into each page
4. Replaces admin-tab links with the modal trigger
5. Optionally redacts career pipeline data (per Option A/B decision above)
6. Outputs a manifest: which pages were captured, timestamp, any failures

Claude Code to propose the implementation approach for the capture script (requests-based HTML capture, Playwright headless browser, or other) and flag any constraints (e.g., JS-heavy pages that need headless rendering vs. server-side templates that can be captured with simple HTTP requests).

Hosting

Claude Code to confirm the cleanest routing given the current Cloudflare + tunnel setup. Working hypothesis: `minimoi.ai/preview/...` served as static files from the Flask app's static directory — no separate host needed if Flask can serve them, always-on because the files don't require the backend to exist. If that's not clean, Cloudflare Pages for `/preview` is the fallback.

Open question: should preview live at `minimoi.ai/preview` or `preview.minimoi.ai`?
Leaning toward `/preview` (simpler, same domain, no DNS change needed), but Claude Code to confirm.

Tier 2 — Live Guest Access (existing plumbing)

Current state (from Claude Code investigation)

Guest access plumbing exists:

- `/register` route
- Telegram alert to Robert on signup
- `/guest/briefing` and related routes

Robert's intent: **on request only** — no public self-service signup link. Guest access is for vetted contacts (recruiters who've had a conversation, interviewers, collaborators).

What Claude Code needs to verify

Before treating this as "done," confirm:

- ☐ `/register` still works end-to-end — signup form → Telegram ping to Robert → Robert grants access (how? manual DB update? a `/approve` route?) → guest can log in
- ☐ What does a guest actually see? Is `/guest/briefing` a real page with real Curator content, or a placeholder?
- ☐ Are guest sessions read-only enforced, or just by convention?
- ☐ Is there a way for Robert to revoke guest access cleanly?

Guest access entry point

Currently no public entry point (no link from landing page). With the preview layer live, the natural entry point is the "Request live guest access →" link in the snapshot banner. This should:

- Link to a contact method (email, LinkedIn DM — Robert to specify)
- **Not** link to `/register` directly (keeps it on-request, not self-service)

If Robert wants a lightweight request form (name, email, reason) that sends a Telegram ping without granting access automatically, that's a small addition to the existing Telegram alert system — flag as optional scope for the build spec.

German domain — Animated walkthrough

Why this needs special treatment

Mein Deutsch's value is in the workflow loop — persona selection, Grok Voice conversation, transcript submission, AI review, Anki card generation. A static screenshot of the Gespräche tab shows the UI but not the *experience*. This is the one domain where a static snapshot is insufficient on its own.

Proposed approach

An **animated walkthrough** embedded in the Mein Deutsch preview section — a CSS/JS animation (not a video file, so no hosting/encoding overhead) that simulates the workflow loop:

1. Persona selection screen — highlight a persona card (e.g., "Frau Weber, Librarian, Vienna")
2. Scene selection — highlight a scenario ("At the coffee shop")
3. Conversation view — typing animation showing sample exchange
4. Transcript submission — "Session ended, submitting transcript..."
5. Review output — reviewer feedback appearing, Anki cards generated

This is a design problem, not just a build problem — the animation needs to be visually compelling and accurate to the actual workflow. Robert wants Grok's input on this concept before Claude Code implements.

For Grok (design brief)

We're building an animated walkthrough for the Mein Deutsch section of a portfolio preview page. The workflow we want to show:

1. Persona selection (e.g., "Frau Weber, Librarian, Vienna")
2. Scene/scenario selection ("At the coffee shop")
3. A short conversation in German (typed animation, speaker-labeled)
4. Transcript submission
5. AI review output + Anki cards generated

Implementation will be CSS/JS animation embedded in a static HTML page — no video file, no external dependencies. The existing design system uses: dark background (● #2A1F14), parchment (□ #F5F0E8), accent amber (□ #C68A5E), Georgia serif headings, Source Sans 3 body.

Questions for Grok:

- What's the right pacing and reveal pattern for each step? (Fade in/out? Scroll-triggered? Auto-advance with delay?)

- Should this be a full-screen takeover in the preview, or a contained panel within the Gespräche tab view?
- What's the right length — 30 seconds? 60 seconds? Loop or one-pass?
- What copy/sample conversation would make the strongest demonstration (short enough to read, real enough to feel authentic)?

Claude Code holds on the animation implementation until Grok's design input is received and Robert approves the concept.

Build spec scope (to follow this document)

Once this design doc is approved, the build spec breaks into three parallel workstreams (Claude Code to confirm sequencing):

1. **Snapshot capture script + `/preview` routing** — the core always-on work. Depends on: hosting decision, career pipeline decision (A vs B).
 2. **Admin tab modal** — small, can be built alongside snapshot capture.
 3. **Guest access audit + entry point** — verify existing plumbing, wire up the "request access" link from the snapshot banner.
 4. **German animation** — blocked on Grok design input. Can be added to the preview after initial snapshot ships (the Gespräche tab snapshot shows the static UI in the meantime).
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Open questions before build spec

- ☐ `/preview` vs `preview.minimoi.ai` — Claude Code to recommend
 - ☐ Career pipeline: Option A (exclude) or Option B (scrub) — Claude Code to recommend after seeing how it looks
 - ☐ Capture mechanism: simple HTTP requests vs. headless browser (Playwright) — Claude Code to recommend based on how JS-heavy the pages are
 - ☐ Guest access "request" entry point — email, LinkedIn DM, or lightweight form? Robert to decide
 - ☐ German animation: concept input from Grok before scoping build
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